

```
function square(num){  
    var num_square = num * num;  
    return num_square;  
}
```

A function basically has the following basic syntax:

```
function(paramater1, paramater2,...)  
{  
    ...statements...  
}
```

If the function needs to return a result, it may do so by using the 'return' keyword, as seen in the example above. In the above example, we could also have directly returned 'num*num' instead of first storing it in a variable.

Datatypes:

JavaScript is a weakly typed language, meaning that variables do not have an implicit type at declaration. When you create a new variable its type depends on the value assigned to it. Conversion between types is also quite simple.

JavaScript has support for strings, dates, arrays, boolean values, and so on, natively. JavaScript also natively supports RegEx, but that is out of the scope of this book.

4.4 DOM

DOM is a standard that specifies how a browser is supposed to represent a web page internally, such that it can be manipulated using JavaScript. When we use JavaScript to change the appearance based on human interaction, DOM defines how we expect to detect the interaction, and how we can access and change the attribute of the document such that its appearance or behaviour is changed.

Since DOM is a general term, it is not specific to HTML only, but any document. In the HTML DOM, the main document is referred to using the object 'document', and this will be the thing we will use the most when working with JavaScript in web pages.

To manipulate an HTML page, we need to do three things – first, we need to find the element / part of the page that we